

Yorkshire Pudding

A steam balloon held up by a fragile gluten-and-egg shell. Bread flour for the cage. ~115% hydration for the steam. Smoking-hot dripping for the seal. A sealed oven door for the climb.

Yield: 12 muffin / 4 popover Active: 20 min Total: 35 min Oven: 230°C (450°F) Fat: smoking

INGREDIENTS

METRIC · VOLUME IN RIGHT COLUMN

THE BATTER

Strong bread flour (12–14% protein)	140g	1 cup
Whole eggs, large (weigh: 220g shelled)	220g	×4
Whole milk (fridge-cold)	220g	~225 ml
Fine sea salt (at the start, not late)	4g	¾ tsp
Cold water (opt. thin)	0–30g	0–2 tbsp

THE FAT (MUST SMOKE)

Beef dripping (or lard / refined oil)	60–80g	—
Per muffin cup	5–7g	1 tsp
Per popover cup	12–15g	2½ tsp

THE FOUR NON-NEGOTIABLES

1. Bread flour	—	—
2. ~115% hydration	—	—
3. Smoking fat	—	—
4. Sealed oven, no peek	—	—

Kit: carbon-steel popover or 12-cup muffin tin · oven thermometer (most ovens read 15–20°C low) · 1 L jug · whisk · sieve · digital scale.

METHOD

- Sieve flour + salt** into a bowl. Make a well. Crack eggs into the well; whisk hard *into* the flour from the centre out — paste, then thick batter, then smooth.
Salt with the flour, never on rested batter — it won't dissolve and you'll taste grains in the crust.
- Stream in cold milk** while whisking until the batter has the consistency of single cream. Pass through a sieve into a 1 L jug.
~115% hydration is the steam fuel. Drier batter = no climb. Volume cups under-pack flour; weigh the four numbers above. — Kenji 2014
- Rest the batter — or don't.** 30 min room temp / overnight in fridge / not at all. Heston rests; Kenji's side-by-side found no difference. Both right.
The four non-negotiables matter more than rest. — Heston 2006 / Kenji 2014
- Heat oven to 230°C** (450°F) fan-off, or 220°C fan. Place empty tin on the centre rack. Verify with thermometer.
- Add fat** after 5 min — 1 tsp dripping per muffin cup, or 2½ tsp per popover. Heat **8–10 min until visibly smoking**. Not shimmering — smoking.
Smoke = 200°C+, hot enough to set the batter base in 1–2 sec and trap steam inside. RSC 2008: "very hot fat" is binding. — RSC 2008
- Pull tin onto open oven door.** Pour cold batter fast — fill each cup ½ to ¾. Will hiss and spit. Correct.
- Slide tin in. Close the door. Do not open it again.**
Each door-open at 230°C drops oven 25–40°C; recovery 90 sec. Unset puddings collapse and never recover. The #1 home failure. — Cloake 2012
- Bake 230°C × 15 min**, undisturbed. Climb happens at minutes 6–12 — watch through the glass.
- Drop to 190°C** without opening the door. Continue **5–10 min** until deep amber and the rims dry. Total 20–25 min muffin / 25–30 min popover.
Drop dries the crust without scorching. First 15 min makes the climb; final 5–10 min sets the colour.
- Pull tin out. Lift puddings free.** 5–7 cm tall (muffin) or 8–12 cm (popover) with a deep crater.

Done: Deep amber, rims dry, hollow crater. **Eat within 5 minutes** — deflates from peak in 10. Time the bake to land as the beef rests.
If you must hold: 90°C oven, rack, uncovered, max 8 min. Never stack. Never foil.

ELEVATION

TIER 1 — NO EXTRA TIME

- True beef dripping** — render from roast trim, freeze in ice-cube trays
- +1 yolk** — richer crust, more tender centre
- Maldon at the rim** — sprinkle as they leave the tin
- Carbon-steel popover** — 8–12 cm climb vs 5–7 cm

TIER 2 — WORTH IT

- 12-hr fridge rest** — Heston's signature; pull 30 min before pour
- Toad-in-the-hole** — brown sausages in dripping, pour batter around
- Used dripping from the roast tin** — peak savoury layer
- Onion gravy fill** — pour into pudding crater at service
- Horseradish cream** — crème fraîche + grated fresh root

TIER 3 — RESTAURANT

- Suet-rendered dripping** — pre-1950s tradition, deepest savoury
- Plate-sized filled Yorkshire** — pudding as the bowl, beef + greens + gravy
- Compound-fat tin** — 60% dripping + 30% bone-marrow + 10% shallot oil
- Yorkshire wrap** — flat tray, slice warm, fill with thin beef + horseradish

TROUBLESHOOT

No rise / flat	Fat not hot. Smoke 8–10 min. Verify oven 230°C.
Climbed then collapsed	Door opened / pulled too early. Bake full 25 min.
Rim crisp, base soggy	Insufficient fat / batter overfilled. 2–3 mm fat depth, fill ½–¾.
Greasy crust	Fat below smoke point. Wait for visible smoke.
Dense, eggy	Plain flour / under-egged. Bread flour, weigh 220g eggs.
Lopsided climb	Fat uneven / oven hot-spot. Spoon evenly.
Pale crust	Oven too low. Verify thermometer; bake to amber.
Stuck to tin	Tin not hot at fat-in. Heat tin first, then add fat.

CHARTER PREP & STORAGE

Pre-mix batter	Mix morning before, fridge sealed jug. Pull 30 min ahead.
Beef-dripping cubes	Render from each roast, freeze in ice-cube trays (~5g each).
Bake to order	Time to land as beef rests. Never hold > 8 min.
No fan oven	230°C, drop to 200°C at min 15. Same climb.
Rough seas	Don't. Pourable hot fat in motion = fire risk.
Don't freeze	Raw batter: eggs/milk separate. Cooked: bake to order.
Shelf life	5 min peak · 10 min decline · gone
Scaling	×2 same temp, two trays. ×4: two batches back-to-back.